TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Share Your View on Working From Home vs the Office

Express Opinion | OREO | Opinion Exchange

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Give your opinion on working from home, support it with a reason and an example, and respond to a different view.

WHO	You work in a small company in Johor Bahru.
SITUATION	The company is deciding whether staff can work from home two days a week. Your colleague Kumar wants to know what people think before Friday's meeting with Mr. Tan.
NEED	Kumar asks for your opinion, and he does not agree with everything you say. At the meeting, Mr. Tan asks you about it too.
GOAL	Give a clear opinion, support it with one reason and one example, and answer a different view politely without giving up your opinion.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Kumar asks: "So, what do you think? Working from home, or coming to the office?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Personally, I think working from home two days a week is a good idea. The main reason is that I can focus better without interruptions. For example, last month I finished the monthly report in one morning at home. In the office, it usually takes me two days. So overall, I know some people miss the team at home, but I'd still prefer a mix of home and office.

O OPINION

R REASON

E EXAMPLE

O OPINION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali gives Kumar a different view. Put his sentences in order: Opinion → Reason → Example → Opinion.

- [ ] For instance, yesterday you and I fixed a customer problem in ten minutes at your desk.
- [ ] That's why I'd rather come in most days.
- [ ] In my opinion, the office is better for our team.
- [ ] This is because we solve problems faster face to face.

Write the letter: **O** = Opinion · **R** = Reason · **E** = Example · **O** = Opinion again

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

STATE YOUR OPINION

- [ ] Personally, I think …
- [ ] In my opinion, …
- [ ] I'd prefer …
- [ ] I feel that …

GIVE A REASON

- [ ] The main reason is that …
- [ ] This is because …
- [ ] …, so …

GIVE AN EXAMPLE

- [ ] For example, …
- [ ] For instance, …
- [ ] Last week, …

CONCLUDE

- [ ] So overall, …
- [ ] That's why …
- [ ] All in all, …

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

- [ ] I see your point, but …
- [ ] That's true. However, …
- [ ] I understand that, but for me …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I like working from home. [because / so / but] I can focus better.

   _____

2. The office is noisy. [but / so / because] I still like seeing my team.

   _____

3. My commute takes an hour. [but / because / so] Working from home saves me a lot of time.

   _____

4. Some people work well at home. [For example, / However, / That's why] New staff need to learn from the team.

   _____

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. I _____ better at home. (An opinion or a fact about now)
   - ○ focusing
   - ○ focus
   - ○ am focus
2. Last month I _____ the report in one morning. (An example that already happened)
   - ○ finish
   - ○ am finishing
   - ○ finished
3. In the office, it usually _____ me two days. (A routine)
   - ○ takes
   - ○ taking
   - ○ take
4. Working from home _____ be lonely for some people. (What might happen)
   - ○ is
   - ○ might
   - ○ was

SLIDE 09 may / might · comparing

An opinion is not a fact. Use may / might when something is possible, and compare with -er / more … than.

Working from home **might** be lonely for some people.

New staff **may** need more support.

Home is **quieter than** the office.

I'm **more productive** at home.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O OPINION

Personally, I think …

R REASON

The main reason is that …

E EXAMPLE

For example, last …

O OPINION AGAIN

So overall, …

SLIDE 11

Opinion Exchange

Tell your view on a card. Your listener writes your opinion, reason and example, then gives a different view. You answer.

1. Round 1 (3:00 each): say your card number, then tell your partner your view: O → R → E → O.
2. Listener: write the listener's note in your workbook, then give one different view. Speaker: acknowledge it, answer.
3. Swap roles. Then new partners (line B moves to the next seat). Round 2 (2:00 each): same card, same view, shorter.
4. New partners again. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed: speakers turn the workbook over. Tell your view once more.

Card 1 · Shared desks

Card 2 · Meetings

Card 3 · Working hours

Card 4 · Open office

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card number			
Their opinion			
Their reason			
Example: what, when			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. I see. But won't some people feel lonely at home?
2. Some managers say people work less at home. What do you think?
3. What about new staff? Can they learn from home?

Start with: **I see your point, but … · That's true. However, … · I understand that, but for me …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend in JB is thinking of moving to Kluang, a smaller town, to save on rent. What is your opinion? Give a reason and an example.

In my opinion, … · The main reason is … · For instance, …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] States a clear opinion.
- [ ] Supports it with a reason and an example.
- [ ] Acknowledges a different view and answers it.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Clear opinion	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason + example	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Responding to another view	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Shared desks

Ask: "What do you think about sharing desks?" Write down their opinion (yes or no), their reason, and their example (what happened, when). Then give one different view.

Card 2 · Meetings

Ask: "Are online meetings as good as meetings in a room?" Write down their opinion, their reason, and their example (what happened, when). Then give one different view.

Card 3 · Working hours

Ask: "Fixed hours or flexible hours?" Write down their opinion, their reason, and their example (what happened, when). Then give one different view.

Card 4 · Open office

Ask: "Open office or quiet rooms?" Write down their opinion, their reason, and their example (what happened, when). Then give one different view.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Shared desks

Should staff share desks on office days? The company wants to take away 8 of the 20 desks, because on most days only 12 people come in. Last Monday, 15 people came in.

Card 2 · Meetings

Are online meetings as good as meetings in a room? Your team meets online three times a week. Last week two people could not connect, but nobody had to drive to the office.

Card 3 · Working hours

Is a fixed 9-to-6 better than flexible hours? With flexible hours you could start at 7.30 and miss the morning traffic jam. But when your team tried it last Tuesday, a customer called at 5.45 and nobody answered.

Card 4 · Open office

Is an open office a good idea, or does everyone need a quiet space? Your office has no walls between desks. Yesterday you made eight calls to customers while two colleagues talked next to you.